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San Diegans Push Back on Flock ALPR Surveillance

Approaching San Diego’s first annual review of the city's controversial Flock Safety contract, a local coalition is calling on the city council to roll back this dangerous and costly automated license plate reader (ALPR) program.

The [TRUST Coalition](#)—a grassroots alliance including [Electronic Frontier Alliance](#) members [Tech Workers Coalition San Diego](#) and [techLEAD](#)—has rallied to stop the unchecked spread of ALPRs in San Diego. We’ve previously covered the coalition’s [fight for surveillance oversight](#), a local effort kicked off by a “smart streetlight” surveillance program five years ago.

In 2024, San Diego installed [hundreds of AI-assisted ALPR cameras](#) throughout the city to document what cars are driving where and when, then making that data accessible for 30 days.

ALPRs like Flock’s don’t prevent crime—they just vacuum up data on everyone who drives past. The resulting [error-prone dragnet](#) can then chill speech and be weaponized against marginalized groups, like [immigrants](#) and those seeking [trans](#) or [reproductive healthcare](#).

Despite local and [state restrictions](#) barring the sharing of ALPR with federal and out of state agencies, San Diego Police have reportedly disclosed license

plate data to federal agencies—including [Homeland Security Investigations](#) and Customs and Border Patrol.

Also, despite a local ordinance requiring city council approval before deployment of surveillance technology, San Diego police have reportedly deployed ALPRs and smart streetlights at Comic-Con and Pride [without the required approval](#).

The local coalition is not alone in these concerns. The [San Diego Privacy Board](#) recently recommended the city reject the Surveillance Use Policy for this technology. All of this [costs the community](#) over \$3.5 million last year alone. That is why the TRUST coalition is calling on the city to reject this oppressive surveillance system, and, instead, invest in other essential services which improve day-to-day life for residents.

San Diegans who want to push back can get involved by [signing the TRUST Coalition's petition](#), [follow the campaign online](#), and contact their [council members](#) to demand the city end its contract with Flock and start respecting the privacy rights of everyone who lives, works, or visits through their community.



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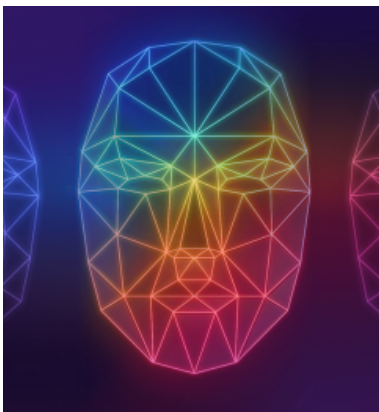


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